see. Things you might not expect are spots that you have to iterate every time you change something else—these are usually indications of code that's too tightly coupled or poorly designed. Spots like this are time-consuming, often simply because of tech debt that needs to be cleaned up. Showing the amount of time spent on problem spots is good evidence that you should fix them for the sake of saving time once the change is made.

4.3.2. Data you can get from centralized SCM

Even though I keep trash-talking SVN and CVS, both are common SCM systems in use by many developers today. This goes back to the fact that changing your SCM system is going to be a disruption to your team at some level. To move from SVN to Git, for example, your team will have to learn Git, stop working while the code gets migrated, migrate the code, and then get used to working in a different workflow. You can definitely expect this to slow your team down temporarily, but the benefits you'll get out of the data alone are worth it. This data will give you such greater insight that it gives you the potential to find problems and shift direction much faster than the data you can get from centralized SCM. The move to DVCS also encourages and fosters better collaboration through pull requests and, in my opinion as a developer, is nicer and easier to use.

If I haven't convinced you yet, you can still get some data out of your centralized SCM system. Basically, you can get who made the change and what the change was, as demonstrated in figure 4.9.

Figure 4.9. The data you can get out of centralized SCM

